**General rule** – saving throws and ability checks · "Playing the Game" chapter of SRD 5.2.1

**D20 Tests** come in three types: **ability checks**, **saving throws** and **attack rolls**. You roll 1d20, add the ability **modifier** and your **Proficiency Bonus** if proficient, and compare to the **DC**. A result equal or higher succeeds.

An **ability check** measures a talent (Strength, Dexterity...); a **saving throw** resists an effect; an **attack roll** hits an AC. The DM only asks for a roll if failure has a cost.

### 🎲 Quick summary:

1. d20 + modifier + proficiency (if proficient).
2. Result ≥ **DC**: success.
3. Ability check: a talent; save: resist; attack: hit.
4. The DM asks for a roll only if **failure matters**.

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### ⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 names the three rolls "D20 Tests" and clarifies that natural 20 and natural 1 only count for attack rolls.

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### ⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

Choosing the DC and ability rests with the DM. Fix: use the DC table and announce the roll before rolling.

### 💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the obstacle and let the player suggest the best-suited ability.

## Step 1 – Set the stakes:

The DM describes what's attempted and what failure risks.

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## Step 2 – Choose the roll:

Which ability? Which skill? Any Advantage or Disadvantage?

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## Step 3 – Roll:

1d20 + modifier + proficiency (if proficient; doubled with Expertise).

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## Step 4 – Compare to the DC:

Equal or higher: success. Otherwise: failure with its consequences.

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## Step 5 – Special cases:

Contest: both roll, higher wins. Group check: at least half succeed.

*Example: Mira picks a lock (Dexterity, Thieves' Tools), DC 15. She rolls 11 + 5 = 16: the lock opens.*

| Difficulty | DC |
|---|---|
| Very Easy | 5 |
| Easy | 10 |
| Medium | 15 |
| Hard | 20 |
| Very Hard | 25 |
| Nearly Impossible | 30 |
| Proficiency Bonus | +2 (lvl 1-4); +3 (5-8); +4 (9-12); +5 (13-16); +6 (17-20) |
| Modifier | (score − 10) ÷ 2, rounded down |

## ⚠ Common questions:

### What is a D20 Test?

An ability check, a saving throw or an attack roll.

### Does a natural 20 always succeed?

Only for attack rolls.

### When do I roll?

When the outcome is uncertain and failure has consequences.

### Skill or ability?

The DM chooses; the player can suggest.

### What is a contest?

Both parties roll; the higher wins.

### Group check?

Everyone rolls; the group succeeds if at least half succeed.

### Is proficiency always added?

Only if you're proficient in the skill or save.

## ⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

### Failure with no cost

Roll if failure costs nothing? **Option**: no, automatic success.

### Retrying

Can I retry? **Option**: only if the situation changes.

### Passive checks

Does a passive score replace a roll? **Option**: for watchfulness.

### Ability choice

Several abilities possible. **Option**: let the player justify.

## ⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

### Death save

A d20 with no modifier: 10 or higher succeeds; natural 1 counts as two failures.

### Expertise

Proficiency is doubled for the skill concerned.

### Help

Help gives Advantage on an ability check for the task.

### Tool and skill

If you're proficient in both tool and skill, you have Advantage.

*These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.*

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